

Fever Management

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A fever is a temporary increase in body temperature, often caused by an illness. For adults, a fever is generally defined as a temperature of 38 C (100.4 F) or higher. Rest and fluids are the first-line supportive care described in this guide.

When to Seek Help

Seek immediate medical attention if a fever reaches 40 C (104 F), lasts longer than three days, or is accompanied by a stiff neck, confusion, or difficulty breathing. These can be signs of a serious infection that requires professional evaluation.

Children and Fevers

For infants younger than three months, any fever of 38 C or higher requires immediate medical evaluation. For older children, supportive care with fluids and rest is usually sufficient unless warning signs appear.

Hydration and Dehydration

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Dehydration occurs when the body loses more fluids than it takes in. Common signs include thirst, dark urine, fatigue, and dizziness. Oral rehydration solutions contain the right balance of salts and glucose to restore fluid levels quickly.

Treatment Guidelines

Mild dehydration can be treated at home with water and electrolyte drinks. Drink slowly and rest in a cool place. Severe dehydration is a medical emergency that may require intravenous fluids under professional care.